

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

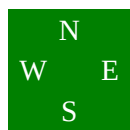
Declarer: East

**Board 1**

North Deals  
None Vul

♠ Q 10 2  
♥ 8 5  
♦ Q 6 4  
♣ J 9 6 3 2

♠ A 9 6 5  
♥ K Q 4 2  
♦ A 8 7  
♣ Q 8



♠ K J 7 3  
♥ A 6 3  
♦ K J 9 2  
♣ 10 4

♠ 8 4  
♥ J 10 9 7  
♦ 10 5 3  
♣ A K 7 5

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          | 1NT   | Pass | 2♣    |
| Pass     | 2♥    | Pass | 3NT   |
| Pass     | 4♠    |      |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4♠ by North  
providing for the discard of a ♦ loser. East might hold the ♦Q so that finesse works.

With both Majors, the correct response to Stayman is 2♥. Partner now bids 3NT.

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Partner denies having 4♥s so obviously he must hold 4♠s. You therefore correct the contract to 4♠, your known 4-4 Major fit.

North plays 4♠. East takes two top ♣s, then leads the ♥J.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 4

There are lots of possibilities for getting rid of one loser. The ♠Q might drop, or she might be in the East hand, finessable. The ♥s might split 3-3,

Suppose you win the ♥ in your hand and try the ♠ finesse. If West has the ♠Q you will then have to find the ♥s splitting, which is not likely, or the ♦Q in the East hand.

A better plan would be to shun the trump Queen finesse entirely. Play the ♠K, then ♠A. If the ♠Q falls then pull the last trump and you are home free.

If the ♠Q DOESN'T fall, play your other two ♥ winners. When West discards on the last ♥ you exit with a small trump to a defender's ♠Q.

If East wins the ♠ you will just have to depend on the ♦ finesse. But if West takes the trick he will be endplayed, having to give you a ruff/sluff in ♣s, or lead into dummy's ♦ K J.

This plan combines several chances.

**Board 3**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 7  
 ♥ A Q 7 2  
 ♦ 8 3  
 ♣ J 10 9 7 5

♠ Q 5 2  
 ♥ J 10 6 4  
 ♦ Q 10 4  
 ♣ K 8 3



♠ K 6 4  
 ♥ K 5  
 ♦ A 9 7 6 2  
 ♣ A Q 4

♠ A 10 9 8 3  
 ♥ 9 8 3  
 ♦ K J 5  
 ♣ 6 2

| West                                       | North | East | South |
|--------------------------------------------|-------|------|-------|
|                                            |       | 1NT  | Pass  |
| 2♣                                         | Pass  | 2♦   | Pass  |
| 2NT                                        | Pass  | 3NT  |       |
| All Pass                                   |       |      |       |
| 3NT by East<br>your ♠K at the first trick. |       |      |       |

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 6

Not only do you need 3 more winners, you need to get them without losing the lead because the instant you lose the lead South will take all his ♠ winners. You can **HOPE** that will only be 3 of them but you can't depend on it.

The ♣ suit is your only hope. If North holds the ♣K you can finesse him out of it. However, if he has ♣K x x and refuses to cover your ♣J, you will have to have a second entry to dummy to cash the good ♣s.

As it happens, you do have two entries, the ♥A and ♥Q! You just have to sacrifice your ♥K to use them both. At trick 2 play your small ♥ to the ♥Q. Play the ♣J, letting it ride when North plays low. Play a small ♣ to your ♣Q. Play the ♣A, dropping North's ♣K. And finally, play your ♥K to dummy's ♥A so you can enjoy cashing those two good ♣s.

Bridge is a nice game.

You sacrifice one sure ♥ winner to create a second dummy entry which creates two ♣ winners.

With 9 points you are in the game-invitational range. And with a 4-card ♥ suit you should use Stayman. You bid 2♣ and partner says 2♦. What is your next bid?

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You are still in game-invitational range, but now you invite partner with 2NT. He replies 3NT and that ends the bidding.

The contract would be 3NT played by West.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♠10. You cross your fingers and put on dummy's ♠J. No good, North covers with the ♠Q and you are forced to take